Judging the burn-scar labels

28 boxes are waiting for a judgement, and they carry the widest part of the project's headline number. Open `data/labels/biak_labels.qgz` in QGIS 3.44 LTR, not 4.2, and fill in the `class` and `confidence` of every box that still has neither.

These labels are the reference that the Task 18 burned-area product is measured against. Nothing else in this project can do that job: the field survey was stopped by security conditions, and F18 showed that no prompted segmentation model can stand in.

What the 28 boxes settle

With 114 of 142 boxes judged, the estimate is **904 ha** and the map being tested claims **819 ha**. Both defensible intervals now put the map inside, which is a change from the state this guide described earlier:

treatment	95% interval	the map's 819 ha
Wilson per stratum (F22)	698 to 1112 ha	inside
Olofsson et al. 2014, normal approximation (F23)	748 to 1060 ha	inside

So the question the remaining boxes answer is no longer whether the two intervals disagree. It is how wide the interval stays, and that is decided almost entirely by one of the two terms:

term	estimate	95% interval	width
commission — area the map claims that did not burn	719 ha	610 to 776	166 ha
omission — area that burned and the map missed	**185 ha**	**88 to 336**	**248 ha**

The omission term is a quarter of the area and carries the larger uncertainty, because it rests on **26 decided units standing for 800 ha of unmapped ground**. The 28 boxes left are all in that stratum. Judging them raises the decided count from 26 towards 54, which roughly halves the standard error on the 23% burned rate behind the 185 ha.

Partial work helps. Every box judged narrows the interval a little, and `scripts/label_accuracy.py` counts the unjudged ones nowhere rather than guessing them, so the figure above is already an honest n=114 result and not a placeholder.

Before you start: which Python

Three Python interpreters are installed on this machine and only one runs these scripts.

interpreter	has	use it for
`.venv`	shapely, no geopandas	nothing here. Scripts die with `ModuleNotFoundError: No module named 'geopandas'`
conda env `geolibre`	geopandas, rasterio, pyproj, sklearn, pytest	**every script in this guide**
QGIS 3.44 LTR python	geopandas, osgeo, no rasterio	only `label_qgis_project.py` and `label_second_pass.py`, which import `qgis.core`

Set two environment variables with it, or pyogrio warns `Could not detect GDAL data files` and the CRS work becomes unreliable:

```
GDAL_DATA=C:/Users/User/.conda/envs/geolibre/Library/share/gdal
PROJ_LIB=C:/Users/User/.conda/envs/geolibre/Library/share/proj
C:/Users/User/.conda/envs/geolibre/python.exe scripts/label_check.py
```

Where this guide says `python scripts/…`, it means that interpreter with those two variables set, except for the two scripts the table sends to QGIS.

What you are looking at

The project holds 85 layers. Four are vectors, and the rest are imagery grouped by acquisition date and then by area.

layer	what it is
LABELS — draw here	142 boxes of 60 x 60 m, already placed. You fill in the class
random_box seed points, 42 of them	the points the first 42 boxes were centred on. The other 100 boxes have no point here
VIIRS footprints (strata, not truth)	375 m circles round the detections, the frame two strata were drawn from
VIIRS/MODIS detections	the individual satellite detections
one group per date: `17/09/2026` … `13/08/2026`	the imagery, 3 area subgroups of 4 layers each
Sentinel-2 20 m: before, mid-episode, after (older, undated)	superseded, switched off, kept only because the dNBR+ product compared these particular chips

Each date group holds one subgroup per event, and each subgroup holds the same four images. Both resolutions are in the same subgroup, so the pair to compare is always together:

```
23/08/2026
  E0301 Anjareuw
    SWIR B12/B8A/B4 — 1 m
    true colour — 1 m
```

```
    SWIR B12/B8A/B4 — 20 m, as the sensor saw it
    true colour — 10 m, as the sensor saw it
  E0313 Yendidori
    …
  E0368 Insumarires
    …
```

layer in an area subgroup	resolution	what it is
`SWIR B12/B8A/B4 — 1 m`	1 m	S2DR4 super-resolved, the one to judge from
`true colour — 1 m`	1 m	S2DR4 super-resolved, for identifying features
`SWIR B12/B8A/B4 — 20 m, as the sensor saw it`	20 m	**native Sentinel-2, unprocessed**
`true colour — 10 m, as the sensor saw it`	10 m	**native Sentinel-2, unprocessed**

The event is named by the subgroup, not repeated on every layer.

The project opens on the `23/08/2026` group, expanded, with all three area subgroups on and the 1 m SWIR layer of each switched on. Every other date starts collapsed and off, with its own area subgroups already ticked, so switching a date on shows it without further clicks. Tick them as you go, and untick a whole area when you want one event on its own.

There is no dNBR+ layer, on purpose. These labels judge that product, so seeing it while judging would make the comparison worthless. Do not add it.

The dates

All three events were first detected between 19 and 22 August and all three ran until 25 August, so no single image shows the whole story. Six dated scenes are in the project.

date	relation to the events	tile cloud	sensor
13 August	**before all three**, 6 to 9 days ahead of the first detection	39.4%	S2C
23 August	mid-episode, the clearest scene in the set, and the field survey's basemap	**0.4%**	S2C
25 August	the last detection day	15.6%	S2A
28 August	after, and the image dNBR+ compared against	41.9%	S2B
2 September	8 days after the last detection	20.1%	S2C
17 September	23 days after, and inside the September episode	37.5%	S2B

A fresh scar reads bright orange on 23 August and fades to dull brown by 28 August. That fading is the most reliable sign you have. Ground that was already open before the event looks the same on every date, and that is the difference between burnt and merely bare.

So the question to answer for each box is not "does this look burnt" but **"did this change between the dates, and does the change look like burning"**. dNBR+ measures change between two looks; judging one date alone asks something different, and the two then disagree for reasons that have nothing to do with accuracy.

13 August is the date that matters most for the boxes that are left. They are all on ground the map does not claim, where the judgement usually turns on whether a dull patch is a scar or was already open. A dated pre-event image answers that directly, and until 2026-10-15 the project had only an undated Earth Engine chip for it.

The cloud column is there because it decides which date can be read at all over a given box. 23 August at 0.4% is clean nearly everywhere. 28 August at 41.9% is not, and a box that looks dark there may be under cloud rather than burnt.

The imagery

SWIR (B12/B8A/B4) is the one to judge from. In it:

what you see	what it is
bright green	healthy vegetation, the greener the denser
brown to maroon, dull red	burnt or bare ground — this is what you are looking for
pale green to cream	grass, dry or sparse cover
near black	water
white, sharp edges	roofs and paved surfaces

Switch to true colour when you want to check what a feature is — a roof, a track, a bare field — because true colour looks like a photograph and SWIR does not.

All four images in a date group share one fixed brightness scale, 1 m and native alike, so these colours mean the same thing in every tile and can be compared between events and between resolutions. (An earlier version of this imagery stretched each channel separately, which showed vegetation orange and burnt ground blue. If you see that, the imagery is stale — see the warning about `label_prepare.py` in the script table.)

The 1 m image is a model's output, and it removes cloud, haze and smoke

This is the most important thing to understand about what is on the screen.

S2DR4 reads the native 10 and 20 m Sentinel-2 bands and generates a 1 m image from them. It does not merely sharpen: it reconstructs, and part of what it reconstructs is **ground that was hidden under cloud, haze or smoke**. Where the sensor saw smoke, the 1 m image shows plausible ground instead.

That is why every date group carries the native 20 m and 10 m chips beside the 1 m pair. **Use them.** The procedure is:

1. Judge on the 1 m SWIR, as before.
2. Before you commit a box, switch on `true colour — 10 m, as the sensor saw it` above the 1 m layer and toggle it.
3. If the native image shows cloud, haze or smoke over the box, **the 1 m pixels under it are reconstruction, not observation**. Mark the box `unsure` and say so in `notes`.

This applies to the boxes already judged as much as to the ones left: the chips have always had this property, and it has only now been made visible. 23 August, where most judging was done, is the least affected date at 0.4% cloud. 28 August (41.9%), 17 September (37.5%), 13 August (39.4%) and 2 September (20.1%) are the ones to check.

Beyond the cloud question, the same caution as always: trust the shape of a patch and the contrast between patches. Do not trust a single sharp edge or a small isolated object. Those are the parts a super-resolution model invents.

The job: judge the boxes

There is nothing to draw. The label layer holds **142 boxes of 60 x 60 m**, 0.36 ha each, which is 9 pixels of the 20 m product being tested. Your job is the judgement only: what is inside each box.

Why fixed boxes rather than outlines: the sample location has to come from the random draw. Choosing where to draw, by eye, around a scar that is visible turns the reference into a collection of obvious cases, and the agreement figure then measures the easy ones only.

Three strata, and what is left in each

`sampling`	how many	judged	drawn from
`random_box`	42	42, done	random points, 7 inside and 7 outside each event's VIIRS footprint
`map_burned`	50	50, done	random points inside the dNBR+ polygons of the three events
`footprint_unmapped`	50	22, **28 left** (`B23` – `B50`)	random points inside the footprints, on ground the polygons do not claim

The 28 that are left split by event as follows:

event	boxes left
E0301 Anjareuw	14
E0313 Yendidori	8
E0368 Insumarires	6

`map_burned` samples the map being tested, so the burned class is well represented there: 36 of its 41 decided boxes came back `burned`. `footprint_unmapped` samples the unclaimed ground directly, which is

where omission shows up, and it is the thinner half of the evidence: 6 of 16 decided, pooled with 0 of 10 `random_box` boxes inside a footprint, is the whole basis of the 23% rate behind the 185 ha omission term.

The three strata are never pooled across frames. Each came from its own draw, so each carries its own inclusion probability, and mixing them would make those probabilities unknowable. The 42 `random_box` boxes keep their place and are still used, but only for the stratum their own draw supports.

Sampling by the map is not circular, because the map is never shown while judging. Judging by the map would be. That is why there is still no dNBR+ layer in the project.

The steps

1. Open the project, select **LABELS — draw here**, and open the attribute table (**F6**).
2. Toggle editing (**Ctrl+E**).
3. Sort by `class` to bring the empty rows together, or filter the table to them. The 28 that are left are `B23` to `B50`.
4. Click a row, then **Zoom to feature**, so the map shows that box.
5. **Look at the dates in turn**, which is the part that decides the answer.
6. Check the native chip for cloud, haze or smoke over the box.
7. Fill `class` with `burned`, `unburned` or `unsure`, and `confidence` with `high`, `medium` or `low`. Use `notes` only if something needs saying.
8. Save (**Ctrl+S**) often.

Step 5 is four questions, in this order:

look at	ask
1 m SWIR, 13 August	was this already open and bare before the event?
1 m SWIR, 23 August	is the box orange, meaning freshly burnt?
1 m SWIR, 28 August	has it gone dull brown, as a scar does in five days?
1 m SWIR, 2 or 17 September	is the scar still there weeks later, as a real one is?

The table also has a **form view** at the bottom right, which shows one box at a time if that reads more comfortably than the grid.

Spelling matters, and `scripts/label_check.py` catches anything unexpected.

What each pattern means

13 Aug	23 Aug	28 Aug	September	read it as
green	orange	brown	brown, fading	burnt during the episode, the clearest case
green	green	brown	brown	burnt between 23 and 25 August
brown or bare	same	same	same	open ground already, not a scar
green	dark patch	green	green	cloud or its shadow, not a scar
green	green	green	brown	burnt after the episode, in the September one. Not these events — `unburned` for this reference, with a note

The last row matters because 2 and 17 September fall inside a second burning episode. These labels judge the August events only.

If a box straddles two cover types

Judge what covers most of it. If it is close to half and half, that is exactly what `unsure` is for.

The rules that keep this honest

- **`unsure` is a real answer, and it is dropped from the denominator.** Thin smoke, cloud shadow, a patch you would argue about — mark it `unsure` and move on. The estimator drops those and reports how many there were. A guessed label is worse than no label, because it silently moves the accuracy figure. Six of the 22 already decided in this stratum came back `unsure`, so expect roughly a quarter of the 28 not to add to the interval. That is the honest outcome, not a failure.
- **Check the native chip before committing.** Where cloud, haze or smoke covers the box in the 20 m or 10 m image, the 1 m pixels are generated. `unsure`, with a note.
- **Do not move a box** to somewhere easier to judge, and do not resize it. The points were drawn at random from a fixed seed; shifting them onto convenient ground is exactly the bias the random draw exists to prevent. A box on water, on a roof or under cloud gets `unsure` and a note.
- **Inside the footprint does not mean burned.** The footprint only says a satellite saw heat within 375 m at some point. Plenty of ground inside it did not burn, and that is precisely what the labels are meant to establish. Judge each patch on the imagery.
- **Outside the footprint does not mean unburned** either. If it looks burned, label it burned.
- **Inside a dNBR+ polygon does not mean burned.** You cannot see the polygons, which is the point. Five of the 50 boxes in that stratum came back `unburned` and nine `unsure`. The stratum is where the map says it burned, not where it did.
- **Do not use the detections as evidence.** They tell you where heat was seen, which is the very thing the product is trying to convert into area. Use them to orient yourself, not to decide.

- **Change is the question, not appearance.** Bare ground that looks the same on every date is `unburned`, however brown it is. That distinction is the whole reason six dates are in the project.
- **Re-judging a box is allowed, and expected.** The first pass was made on one date only, before the pre-event and post-event dates existed and before the native chips were there to check against. If a box reads differently with the sequence in front of you, change it and say why in `notes`. Nothing is gained by defending an earlier call.

When you are done, or partway through

```
python scripts/label_check.py
python scripts/label_accuracy.py
```

`label_check.py` reports how many boxes exist, the class counts by stratum, the polygon sizes, and anything malformed or misspelled. It changes nothing.

`label_accuracy.py` is the one that produces the answer. It prints the two-stratum estimate with **both** intervals, the Wilson one and the Olofsson one, splits the figure into its commission and omission terms, says whether each interval puts the map's 819 ha inside or outside, and reports how many boxes are still unjudged and therefore counted nowhere. It writes `data/processed/label_accuracy.json`.

Partial work is fine. Both scripts say what is left and the interval simply stays wider.

When all 100 drawn boxes are judged, re-run `src/burn_classifier.py` as well: more positives in the unmapped stratum is what its weakest fold needed. **Do not retune it** because the sample grew — same features, same defaults, same leave-one-event-out folds.

A new `FINDINGS.md` entry is owed once the 28 are judged: the 904 ha result and its crossover against F20, written at review, as this project's convention requires.

The scripts, in the order you need them

script	interpreter	what it does
`scripts/label_prepare.py`	geolibre	already run, and **must not be run again**. It rewrites the sample points and renames the dated chips to plain names, which would break both the draw and the date groups
`scripts/label_imagery_add.py`	geolibre	the way to add or refresh imagery now. Writes the dated 1 m pairs and the native chips beside them. Leaves existing 1 m chips alone unless you pass `--force`
`scripts/label_pre_imagery.py`	geolibre	already run: pulled the undated 20 m before, mid and after chips from Earth Engine. Superseded by the dated groups
`scripts/label_qgis_project.py`	**QGIS**	rebuilds `biak_labels.qgz`, one group per date and one subgroup per area. Never touches the GeoPackage, so judgements survive a rebuild. Refuses to run if the project holds polygon annotations, unless you pass `--force`
`scripts/label_add_boxes.py`	geolibre	draws more `map_burned` or `footprint_unmapped` boxes at random, at least 150 m from any existing one
`scripts/label_fill_ids.py`	geolibre	only if you add polygons by hand: fills `sample_id` and `event_id` from the point inside each polygon
`scripts/label_check.py`	geolibre	reports what is there and what is wrong. Changes nothing
`scripts/label_accuracy.py`	geolibre	the estimate, both intervals, and the two terms. Changes nothing but its own JSON
`scripts/label_second_pass.py`	**QGIS**	the second-interpreter machinery. Nobody is running it — see below
`scripts/s2dr4_dates.py`	geolibre	what date a given request will actually return, and which scenes exist over a tile
`scripts/s2dr4_compare.py`	geolibre	compares two S2DR4 tiles pixel by pixel. How the 2026-10 run was shown to hold the same scenes as the 2026-08 one
`scripts/label_howto_pdf.py`	geolibre	renders this file to `data/labels/panduan-penilaian-label.pdf`

Never invent a label, a geometry or a coverage number to get a script to finish. If a box cannot be drawn, a file cannot be read or a count does not come out, the script exits non-zero and names the problem. A fabricated reference label is worse than a missing one: it moves the accuracy figure and leaves no trace that it did.

The second interpreter: not happening

No second person is available, and F24 records that as a permanent limitation rather than a gap to be filled later. Do not build towards it, and do not fill `data/processed/label_agreement.json` with a number: `compared: 0` and a null kappa are the honest state.

Every figure in this project comes from one person reading one set of images. The write-up says so in these words: *the reference is one interpreter's reading, and inter-interpreter agreement was not measured*. Not "the labels were validated", and not "ground truth".

A second pass has to be a different person. The same person re-judging measures how consistent one reader is with themselves. That is a real thing to measure and it may be worth doing, but it is not agreement between interpreters and must never be reported as one.

The machinery stays, because it costs nothing to keep and works the day someone is available, for part of the boxes as well as all of them:

```
python scripts/label_second_pass.py            # build the second file and its project
python scripts/label_second_pass.py --compare   # kappa, agreement, disagreements
```

The first command writes `data/labels/biak_labels_pass2.gpkg` and `biak_labels_pass2.qgz`: the same 142 boxes and the same imagery, with `class`, `confidence` and `notes` emptied, so the second reader cannot see the first answers. **Do not open the pass-2 project for your own judging** — the boxes you are filling in live in `biak_labels.qgz`, and anything entered in the pass-2 file is either lost or mistaken later for a second reader's work.

`--compare` counts only the boxes both passes judged and reports the rest as `not_compared`, so a partial second pass still gives a usable figure. Neither answer wins automatically: the disagreement rate is the result, and deciding a reconciled label is the owner's job, box by box, with a reason recorded.